

Wi-Fi-based asset-tracking solutions can help organizations achieve rapid return on investment (ROI) by leveraging their 802.11 wireless network for more than just data connectivity. It reviews the key organizational, business process and technological factors that contribute to the rapid deployment of 802.11 WLAN infrastructures within the enterprise arena to enhance visibility, deliver bottom line financial benefits and effectively address recent federal guidelines for better IT asset management.

WLAN Drivers In The Enterprise

Numerous factors are contributing to the rapid deployment of 802.11 WLANs in the enterprise, including organizational and business process requirements, government and industry standards and new technological developments. These include the increased demand for mobile information access by personnel, as well as the maturation of 802.11 standards and the proliferation of 802.11-enabled devices.

The following are seven key drivers for the rapid deployment of 802.11 WLANs in enterprise IT environments:

1. Intrinsically high levels of mobile staff who demand access to the same information whether they are mobile or at their workstations.
2. Strong benefits for customer service and organizational efficiency through more timely and accurate information access.
3. Maturation of the 802.11 family of standards to provide high speed (802.11a/g), secure (802.11i) and reliable networks offering good quality of service (802.11e/k).
4. Data security guidelines that are driving the need for strong security measures such as those specified by the latest 802.11i standards.
5. Proliferation of 802.11 enabled devices including note-